CBSE CLASS 10 SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER

SUBJECT: SOCIAL SCIENCE (CIVICS) • CHAPTER 1: POWER SHARING

Time Allowed: 3 Hours **Maximum Marks:** 80 Marks

General Instructions:

1. The question paper comprises five Sections – A, B, C, D and E.
2. Section A contains 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) carrying 1 mark each.
3. Section B contains 4 Very Short Answer Type Questions carrying 2 marks each.
4. Section C contains 3 Short Answer Type Questions carrying 3 marks each.
5. Section D contains 3 Long Answer Type Questions carrying 5 marks each.
6. Section E contains 1 Case-Based Question carrying 4 marks.
7. All Questions are compulsory. Internal choices are provided wherever applicable.

SECTION A: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS (1 Mark Each)

1. What is the percentage of French-speaking people in the total population of Belgium who live in the Wallonia region?

(a) 59 percent
(b) 1 percent
(c) 40 percent
(d) 80 percent

2. In the capital city Brussels, a separate government was accepted by both communities. What was the unique composition of this Brussels government?

(a) Equal representation for French-speaking and Dutch-speaking people
(b) Proportional representation based strictly on numerical majority
(c) Domination of the German-speaking minority
(d) Rule by a unitary single-party executive appointed by the King

3. Consider the following statements regarding Sri Lanka:
Statement I: Sri Lanka emerged as an independent country in 1948.
Statement II: The leaders of the Sinhala community sought to secure dominance over government through their numerical majority.
Which of the following options is correct?

(a) Only Statement I is true
(b) Only Statement II is true
(c) Both statements are false
(d) Both Statement I and Statement II are true

4. An Act was passed in Sri Lanka in 1956 to recognize Sinhala as the only official language, disregarding Tamil. Which community felt alienated and discriminated against by this policy?

(a) The Indian Tamil community exclusively
(b) The Sri Lankan Tamils and Indian Tamils
(c) The Buddhist clergy
(d) The Muslim trading minority only

5. Why is power sharing often considered good from a prudential perspective?

(a) It upholds the intrinsic moral value of democratic participation

(b) It eliminates all political competition entirely

(c) It helps to reduce the possibility of violent conflict and social instability

(d) It speeds up executive decision-making without public consultation

6. Which of the following best captures a moral reason for power sharing?

(a) Power sharing is valuable because it is the very spirit of democracy

(b) It prevents economic inflation and stabilizes currency rates

(c) It increases the military budget of the state

(d) It ensures that no coalition government ever collapses

7. **Assertion (A):** Power sharing is good because it helps to reduce the possibility of conflict between social groups. **Reason (R):** Social conflict often leads to violence and political instability, and power sharing ensures the unity of the nation.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

8. What is a distinctive feature of the 'Community Government' elected in Belgium?

(a) It has power over economic taxation and foreign defense policies

(b) It is restricted only to the capital city of Brussels

(c) It is appointed directly by the European Union council

(d) It deals with cultural, educational, and language-related issues

9. Power sharing among the legislature, executive, and judiciary is known as what type of distribution of power?

(a) Vertical division of power

(b) Community power sharing

(c) Horizontal distribution of power

(d) Federal division of power

10. In a federal form of government, power is shared between the general government for the entire country and governments at the provincial or regional level. This system represents:

(a) Vertical division of power

(b) Horizontal checks and balances

(c) Exclusive autocratic rule

(d) Power sharing among pressure groups

11. The system of 'reserved constituencies' in assemblies and the Lok Sabha in India is an example of power sharing among:

(a) Different political parties

(b) Different social groups, such as religious and linguistic or weaker sections/castes

(c) The executive and the judiciary

(d) Central and state governments

12. When two or more parties form an alliance to contest elections or share power after failing to secure a clear majority individually, it results in a:

(a) Unitary dictatorship

(b) Community administration

(c) Judicial review commission

(d) Coalition government

13. Which of the following statements accurately differentiates prudential and moral reasons for power sharing?

(a) Prudential reasons are based on ideology, while moral reasons are based on economic calculations

(b) Prudential reasons apply only to monarchies, whereas moral reasons apply only to federations

(c) Prudential reasons stress tangible outcomes like stability, while moral reasons highlight the intrinsic value of democratic participation

(d) There is no fundamental difference between the two concepts

14. In what year did Sri Lanka achieve independence as a modern nation-state?

(a) 1948

(b) 1956

(c) 1947

(d) 1960

15. **Assertion (A):** The Belgian leaders amended their constitution four times between 1970 and 1993.
Reason (R): They wanted to work out an arrangement that would enable everyone to live together within the same country.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

16. Which language is spoken by the majority of the population in the Flemish region of Belgium?

(a) French

(b) German

(c) English

(d) Dutch

17. In a true democracy, a legitimate government is one where citizens acquire a stake in the system through:

(a) Absolute control by the military elite

(b) Mandatory religious conversion

(c) Participation and voice in governance

(d) Financial donations to political candidates

18. Under horizontal power sharing, how does the system of 'checks and balances' function among government organs?

(a) Each organ checks the others, ensuring a balance of power and no single organ holds absolute control

(b) The judiciary has complete supremacy over the legislature and executive

(c) The legislature handles all judicial disputes without courts

(d) The executive can dissolve courts at any time without a legal basis

19. What are the two major sub-groups of the Tamil-speaking population in Sri Lanka?

(a) French Tamils and German Tamils

(b) Sri Lankan Tamils and Indian Tamils

(c) Northern Tamils and Southern Tamils exclusively based on religion

(d) Muslim Tamils and Buddhist Tamils

20. **Assertion (A):** Democratic systems require citizens to be consulted on how they are governed.
Reason (R): A legitimate government is one where citizens acquire a stake in the system through participation, which forms the moral justification for power sharing.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

SECTION B: VERY SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (2 Marks Each)

21. Mention the ethnic composition of Belgium regarding its language-speaking population.

22. What is meant by the term 'Majoritarianism'? Give an example of a country that adopted it.

23. Define 'Checks and Balances' in a democratic setup.

24. State one prudential reason and one moral reason for power sharing.

SECTION C: SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (3 Marks Each)

25. Describe the path of accommodation adopted by Belgian leaders to resolve regional differences and cultural diversities.

26. How did the feelings of alienation grow among the Sri Lankan Tamils after independence? Explain with three reasons.

27. Differentiate between the Horizontal and Vertical forms of power sharing with suitable examples.

SECTION D: LONG ANSWER QUESTIONS (5 Marks Each)

28. "Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy." Justify this statement with five suitable arguments.

29. Compare and contrast the ways in which Belgium and Sri Lanka dealt with the problem of cultural and ethnic diversities.

30. Explain the four modern forms of power sharing in democracies, providing examples for each.

SECTION E: CASE-BASED / SOURCE-BASED QUESTIONS (4 Marks)

31. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

> *"An advanced form of power sharing can be seen in the system of Community Government in Belgium. This government is elected by people belonging to one language community – Dutch, French, and German-speaking – no matter where they live. This government has the power regarding cultural, educational, and language-related issues. In a democracy, power can also be shared among different social groups such as religious and linguistic groups."*

Q31.1: Which unique form of government was introduced in Belgium to handle cultural and language-related issues? *(1 Mark)*

Q31.2: Who elects the Community Government in Belgium? *(1 Mark)*

Q31.3: Why is sharing power among diverse social groups considered essential in a deeply diverse society? *(2 Marks)*